

FORGE Phase 1 • Week 4 • Session 11 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 11: Trauma Responses in the Dorm" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 11 as written runs the full 120 minutes, so the run of show adds no outside talk (an optional one is listed below). The two videos take about four minutes: the first stands in for your opening words, the second takes the first two and a half minutes of the Instruction segment.

What's in this insert

- **Video 11A, "Trauma Responses in the Dorm"** (1 min 32 s). Acknowledges that the last session was heavy ("If stuff came up, name it. This room can hold it."), recaps Session 10, says what today holds, and ends on the check-in question, held on screen for 20 seconds.
- **Video 11B, "Fight, Flight, Freeze, Fawn"** (2 min 18 s). The four survival responses on screen one at a time, each with what the brain says and what it looks like; "none of them are weaknesses"; "the trigger is in the present, the reaction is from the past"; and reacting vs. responding side by side. It ends on the mentor's question: "Look past the behavior. Ask: what was triggered?"
- **No talk in the run of show.** The session as written already fills two hours. An optional talk for other times is listed below.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Opening Circle: Video 11A , then the check-in round	10	Play it as soon as the men are seated. It ends on "How did you sleep last night? And how are you sitting with last session's material?" Start the round from there. Watch closely for anyone who seems significantly impacted, as the guide says, and plan a private check-in after the session.
0:10	Review & Reflection	10	Video 11A has given the recap of Session 10. Give the guide's reinforcement in your own words ("not about looking backward and staying there") and take questions on Session 10's material.
0:20	Instruction, Part 1: The Four Trauma Responses	15	Play Video 11B first (2½ minutes). Hand out the trauma responses reference sheet after it, then the guide's lines on survival strategies.
0:35	Instruction, Part 2: What These Look Like in the Dorm	15	As written. The four dorm examples are yours; the video does not act any of them out.
0:50	Instruction, Part 3: Why Situations Trigger Disproportionate Reactions	10	Video 11B has previewed reacting vs. responding. Start with the bump-in-the-hallway example, then the guide's lines on the gap and on what FORGE mentors will see.
1:00		30	As written.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
	Practice: Identifying Trauma Responses in Dorm Situations		
1:30	Debrief & Discussion: "Which trauma response is yours?"	20	As written.
1:50	Checkout & Assignment	10	As written.

A note on how the videos handle this material

The four responses are shown as words on a card, not acted out. No clip shows a confrontation, a threat or anyone being pressured. The one clip of a man pacing angrily shows an older man sitting calmly with open hands beside him, and it runs under the line "recognize these responses, in yourself and in others, without judgment." Video 11B lists "sleeping all day" under flight but leaves substance use out; the guide's full list is on the reference sheet.

Optional talk (if time allows)

The session as written already runs two hours, so this talk is not in the run of show. Use it for a make-up session, when a segment runs short, or to prepare yourself before the session.

John Rigg, *The effect of trauma on the brain and how it affects behaviors* (TEDxAugusta 2015; length not confirmed, so preview it for length). A Georgia physician who ran the Traumatic Brain Injury Clinic at Fort Gordon explains the fast "animal brain" that reacts before the thinking brain, with two everyday examples: a soldier who dives to the ground at concert fireworks, and a couple whose argument over the trash starts with a face and a tone, not the words. He also covers learning to notice your thoughts instead of obeying them, and calming the body with exercise, sleep, relaxation and meditation.

Preview note: in passing he lists what soldiers saw in war ("blood, guts, death, body parts") and mentions children growing up in abusive homes; there are no graphic stories or images.

Discussion questions:

1. What are the "fireworks" in a dorm: the sounds, looks or moments that set off a reaction before anyone has time to think?
 2. In the trash argument, the husband reacted to his wife's face and tone, not her words. How does that match "the trigger is in the present, the reaction is from the past"? What would responding, instead of reacting, have looked like?
 3. He says you can learn to watch your thoughts instead of acting on them. How is that the same gap FORGE's tools (STOP, 4-4-4 breathing, grounding) create between the trigger and your action?
- **YouTube** (TEDx Talks channel): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=m9Pg4K1ZKws>
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Getting a copy you can play without internet

Download both MP4 files from forgementors.org/media.html and copy them to the playback device before the week starts. The room needs no internet connection.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 11A and 11B loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Trauma responses reference sheets ready to give out right after Video 11B